

Setting up BOSS on Windows

This is the Windows guide. If you are on a Mac, open `INSTALL-MAC.md` instead. Following the wrong one will send you looking for things your computer does not have.

Two parts. Part 1 is your Business Brain. Part 2 installs your Operating System, and only applies once you have bought it.

You need: your laptop, and Claude Pro or higher. The free plan will not work.

One naming thing before you start. The app you download is called Claude. Your system is called **BOSS**, and it lives inside Claude. When this guide says BOSS, it means your system talking back to you.

What it looks like while it's working

Read this part before you start, because it is the thing that makes people think they broke something.

BOSS talks while it works. It will say things like *"I found an error," "that path was wrong, fixed it," "this one is missing, installing it now."* Sometimes for a while, and sometimes fast enough that you cannot read it all.

That is the system working. It is not the system breaking.

You are installing more than a hundred employees at once. Train a hundred real people on their first day and things go sideways all day long. The difference here is that BOSS finds its own problems, fixes them while you watch, and tells you it did. The talking is the repair.

Let it run. It stops and asks you clearly when it needs something from you, and that is the only time you have to do anything.

When something actually is wrong

Three things, in this order.

1. **Take a screenshot** of whatever you are looking at.
2. **Give the screenshot to BOSS and ask it to fix itself.** Drag the image straight into the same session and say *"fix this."* It reads its own errors and repairs them more often than not. This is the one to try first, every time.
3. **Bring it to office hours** if it is still stuck. That is exactly what office hours are for, and somebody else has usually hit the same thing.

Do not email anyone about it. Not Krista, not the team. It does not get you an answer faster, and the answer is almost always number 2.

If you are in the room right now, raise your hand.

Part 1: Build your Business Brain

1. Download the file on your LAPTOP

Open a browser on the laptop you are going to work on and go to the address on the screen.

Do not scan the QR code with your phone. The file has to land on the laptop. If you already scanned it on your phone, no problem: open your email on the laptop and the download link is in there.

Enter your name, your email, and the password on the screen.

2. Extract it. This is the step people get wrong.

The file is `BOSS-AI-Business-Brain.zip` and it lands in your Downloads folder.

Right-click it, choose Extract All, then click Extract.

Double-clicking a zip on Windows opens a window that *looks* like a folder. It is not one. Nothing has been unpacked, and Claude cannot read a folder that is still zipped. If you skip this step everything after it fails in a way that makes no sense.

You will know it worked when there is a folder next to the zip, with the same name and no zipper on the icon.

3. Open the Claude app

The app on your computer, not claude.ai in a browser. If you do not have it, get it at **claude.ai/download** and run the installer.

4. Point it at your folder

Click **Code** at the top. Start a **new** session. Click **Select folder**.

Choose the folder you just extracted, the one with **START-HERE.md** sitting directly inside it.

If you open that folder and see another folder with the same name inside, go one level in and pick that one. Extract All often creates that extra layer.

If you cannot find the folder you just made: look in **OneDrive**. If OneDrive backup is switched on, which it is on most computers by default, your real Desktop and Documents live inside OneDrive and the plain ones are empty. Search for **START-HERE** in File Explorer and it will find it.

5. Click Trust

Claude asks once whether you trust this folder. Click **Trust**. That is Claude protecting you, not something going wrong.

There is no second permission box on Windows. If you are watching for one, stop watching and move on.

6. Say hi

That is it. You do not type anything special. Say hi, or say nothing at all, and it starts on its own.

It asks you questions and writes your files while you answer. About 90 minutes.

Want to talk instead of type? Press `Windows + H` and answer out loud. Most people go a lot faster this way.

7. Create your free GitHub account when it asks

Near the end it walks you through it and saves your username. Two minutes.

When you finish

Keep that folder. Do not move it, do not rename it, do not delete it.

It is your brain, it is your backup, and you open it again in Part 2.

Part 2: Install your Operating System

Only once you have bought it. Do these in order. Nothing works if you skip one.

First: sign your contract and make your down payment. Nothing unlocks until both are done, because the automation checks for the signed contract.

1. **Scan the code at the back table** to open the access form. Your phone is fine for this one. - Give your GitHub username. Not your email, not a link. - Choose **Agent/Lender** or **Other**. This picks which system you get.
2. **Submit.** The invite fires automatically. You do not email anyone.
3. **You do not have to accept the invite right now.** It waits in your GitHub account and you accept it during setup. It shows up at github.com under your notifications once you are signed in.
4. **Open the SAME folder** you built your brain in. Not a new download.
5. **Type:** `start phase two`

From there your AI does the whole install and tells you when to do something. It installs the tools it needs and tells you exactly which download to pick when there is a choice.

At the end it tells you to open a new session in your new folder and type `set up my OS`. Do that and you are finished.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What it means
"You need to upgrade"	You are on the free Claude plan. Claude Pro or higher at claude.ai
Nothing happened when you opened the folder	You picked the zip, not the extracted folder. Right-click the zip, Extract All, then pick the new folder

What you see	What it means
I cannot find the folder I extracted	Look under OneDrive. Search START-HERE in File Explorer
It is asking me the questions again	It did not find your Day 1 folder. Open the original one
I closed Claude but nothing reset	Closing the window leaves it running. Find the Claude icon in the system tray by the clock, right-click, Quit, watch it disappear, then reopen
No GitHub email	You do not need it. Sign in at github.com and check your notifications
I scanned the QR on my phone	Open your email on your laptop. The link is in there
"404" or "not found"	You accepted the invitation while signed into a different GitHub account
A "Create PR" button appeared	Ignore it. Close it with the X
It says a command was not found right after I installed something	Close the terminal window and open a new one, then try again

Go back to **When something actually is wrong** at the top: screenshot it, hand it to BOSS, ask it to fix itself. Office hours if it is still stuck. Never email.